HEARTHWORK

Family Rules Printable

Simple printables for families who want rhythm, not chaos.

Inside this kit:

- Our Family Rules poster with 7 starter rules
- Fill-in family rules poster with a family signature line
- House rules picture cards for little kids
- Rules and make-it-right chart
- 36 house rule ideas checklist
- Family rules by age (2 to 12)

Print on US Letter at 100% scale. Black and gray ink friendly.
Tip: slip pages into a dry-erase sleeve to reuse every week.

Personal and household use only. Please do not resell or redistribute.

Our Family Rules

Print, post at kid height, and read it together once a week.

We tell the truth.

We speak kindly.

We keep our hands gentle.

We listen the first time.

We clean up our own messes.

We say sorry and forgive.

We help each other.

Our Family Rules (Fill In)

Write 5 to 7 rules together. Say what to do, not only what not to do.

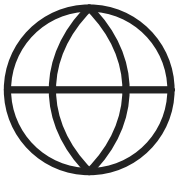
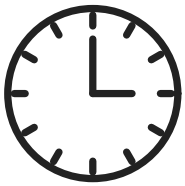
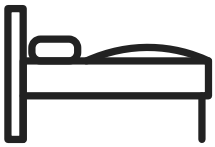
#	Our rule	Why it matters
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

We made these rules together on (date):

Signed by everyone in our family:

House Rules Picture Cards

For kids who cannot read yet. Cut out, laminate, and post the 3 to 5 that matter most right now.

Gentle hands	**Clean up toys**	**Wash hands**
Shoes by the door	**Eat at the table**	 **Balls go outside**
 **Screens off on time**	**Take care of books**	 **Stay in bed**
draw a picture or glue a photo _____	draw a picture or glue a photo _____	draw a picture or glue a photo _____

Rules and Make It Right

Decide ahead of time, so nobody has to invent a consequence while upset.

Our rule	If we break it	How we make it right

Our reset routine (for example: sit, breathe, talk, try again):

House Rule Ideas

Check the ones that fit your family. Keep the posted list short.

- ☐ We tell the truth
- ☐ We speak kindly
- ☐ Gentle hands and feet
- ☐ Listen the first time
- ☐ Ask before you take
- ☐ Knock on closed doors
- ☐ Inside voices inside
- ☐ Walk in the house
- ☐ Clean up before the next thing
- ☐ Put things back
- ☐ Shoes off at the door
- ☐ Coats and bags on hooks
- ☐ Eat at the table
- ☐ Try one bite
- ☐ Clear your own plate
- ☐ Say please and thank you
- ☐ Wait your turn to talk
- ☐ No name calling
- ☐ Say sorry and make it right
- ☐ Forgive quickly
- ☐ Help without being asked
- ☐ Share what is shared
- ☐ Ask before friends come over
- ☐ Screens in shared rooms
- ☐ Screens off at the set time
- ☐ No phones at meals
- ☐ Homework before screens
- ☐ Stay in bed after lights out
- ☐ Tell a grown-up where you go
- ☐ Seatbelts on before we drive
- ☐ Treat others the way you want
- ☐ Look for someone to include
- ☐ Do chores before play
- ☐ Be on time
- ☐ Honor your parents
- ☐ Leave it better than you found it

Our own ideas

Family Rules by Age

Fewer rules, said the same way every time, kept every time.

- [ ] Ages 2 to 3: 3 rules at most, with pictures. Gentle hands, clean up toys, stay with a grown-up. Show the rule, then help them do it.
- [ ] Ages 4 to 6: 4 to 5 rules in short positive words. Practice them when calm, like a game. Use the picture cards.
- [ ] Ages 7 to 9: 5 to 7 rules, with the reason for each. Let them help write the list and sign it.
- [ ] Ages 10 to 12: add rules for screens, friends, and time away from home. Ask them to suggest one rule and one consequence.
- [ ] Tip: read the rules at a weekly family meeting and change one thing at a time. A rule nobody keeps should be fixed or dropped.

Rules we want to work on this month